Yes on Measure Z
Ballot Argument
299 Words

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ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE Z

Vote YES on Measure Z to protect existing homeowners while asking future development and higher-value property sales to help maintain Benicia's essential services and infrastructure.

- Measure Z is not an annual property tax. It applies only when taxable real property is sold.
- **Most importantly, existing homes built before January 1, 2027** that sell for $2 million or less are EXEMPT.
- Family transfers—including between parents and children, grandparents and grandchildren, siblings, spouses and domestic partners—are **EXEMPT.**
- Restricted affordable housing is also **EXEMPT.**

For other taxable property sales, Measure Z uses graduated rates ranging from $4 to $8 per $1,000 of sale price, depending on the value of the transaction. Here are some examples:

1. If a new home built in 2027 sells for $850,000, the formula would be:

   $850,000 x 0.004 = $3,400 (tax)

2. In January 2026, Blue Rise Ventures purchased 1.2 million square feet of industrial buildings. If Benicia had this tax in place, this would be the formula:

   $145,000,000 x 0.008 = $1,160,000 (tax)

Measure Z provides locally controlled funds that can help maintain the essential services and infrastructure Benicia residents rely on—including:

- Police, fire and emergency response
- Streets, pothole repairs, storm drains and sidewalks
- Community facilities such as the library, parks, pool and marina.

Accountability is built in. Measure Z requires annual financial audits and citizen oversight. The funding remains in Benicia for local governmental services.

Measure Z focuses responsibility where it belongs: **existing homes that sell for $2 million or less are protected,** while newly constructed properties, commercial properties and higher-value transactions can contribute when they are sold.

Measure Z takes effect only if voters also approve Measure Y.

Protect existing homeowners. Make growth help support the services it depends on. Keep the money local and accountable.

Vote YES on Measure Z.

s/ Steve Young
Mayor

s/ Trevor Macenski
Vice Mayor

s/ Wendy S Phillips

s/ Allison Costelow

s/ Terrence Bennett